Woods & manufactured boards

Higher · Materials & manufacture · Answers

Answers and marking guidance

Award one mark per correct, developed point unless stated. Other valid answers should be credited.

2 Describe two advantages and one disadvantage of using solid oak for the top.

- Advantage: very durable, resists knocks and scratches
- Advantage: attractive grain gives a quality look and a higher selling price
- Advantage: can be sanded and refinished if damaged
- Disadvantage: expensive compared with manufactured board
- Disadvantage: can warp, twist or crack as moisture changes
- Disadvantage: heavy, which raises transport cost

No marks for: Two disadvantages and one advantage: marks for the correct ones only

3 Quick check

- a) Flexi-ply
- b) To reduce warping and add strength
- c) Ash
- d) Spruce

4 Key terms

- 1 – E
- 2 – F
- 3 – A
- 4 – C
- 5 – D
- 6 – B

5 Give the properties and one use of MDF.

- Fine wood fibres and glue: smooth, flat, easy to machine. Flat-pack.

6 Describe the advantage of manufactured boards.

- Cheap, large stable sheets that don't warp; uses waste wood.